



Google buys API.AI

Google acquires team behind API.AI - a tool that to build conversational bots like Siri.
<http://digit.in/GglAPIAI>



Fujifilm's GFX 50S

Fujifilm unveiled GFX 50S mirrorless digital camera and GFX camera system.
<http://digit.in/FFGFX50S>



Every month we recognise the best article written by our community members and publish it here. Keep up the good work, Digitians!

Creating quality videos on a budget

What is it that sets apart an amateur and a professional movie? Definitely not the camera. Read ahead to know how you can create quality videos like the pros without breaking the bank.



Praneet Sab

Videos are a visual form of conveying stories and they won't appeal the audience if something isn't right with them. Fault could be with the story, narration or maybe the quality. Unless you are any movie director from Bollywood, chances are that this article will benefit you in improving the third aspect, quality, of your low budget movie or say, a video that will

end up on YouTube.

Instead of spending a lot of money and then time to learn expensive gadgets, why not try and learn to get the best out of equipment you already own. Right now, I'm assuming that your camera can shoot at 1080p (with quality that you're satisfied with) and a microphone (or a super quiet environment). For the software part we'll use Adobe's Premiere Pro and After Effects. And finally we require a computer with lots of RAM (unless being patient is fine with you). Let's dive in and take your video up-a-notch.

Color Grading

Video is just amalgam of colors and changing colors can result in a totally different feel because people relate colors with feelings. But color grading would never be the same between two films, so you really need to experiment on your own and choose the best for your shot.



Before and after - Colorista III

Before you color grade, it is suggested that you set your camera's color profile to 'flat' (most DSLRs have this option) or choose the least vibrant color profile since we're aiming for a flat/monotonous look. Also, color grade the movie when it is entirely edited because you won't like to waste time color grading a footage that you won't use. In Premiere Pro CC, you can use effects like "RGB Curves", "Color Balance" and "Three-Way Color Corrector" to color grade your movies. From the 'Effects' panel from the lower left corner, drop them on the clips. Then go to the "Effects Controls" and edit the colors yourself. If those settings are hard for you then you might go ahead with 'Red Giant's Magic Bullets Colorista III' plugin which is user friendly but comes with a \$200 price tag.

Camera Stabilization

Nobody likes to watch a movie that's shaky unless the shot demands it. The best you can do for a moving shot is to either buy a glidecam (which probably cost more than your camera) or you can try your best to keep your hands steady and later stabilize the footage. Adobe Premiere Pro provides an effect called "Warp Stabilizer" that works very well for our purpose



Cheapest Glidecam for a DSLR @ \$249

Background Music

Choosing the best music for your movie is really important, but at the same time you wouldn't want to infringe any copyrights and therefore the music you choose must be either free to use or made by you (check out August's issue that has a beginner's guide to making your own music). You can use YouTube's own library of music that is free and legal to use. You can also head over to www.soundcloud.com. Before you use an artist's music, message them and ask for permissions.